Category Policy Addendum: Furniture

KARTWAY OPERATIONS MANUAL
ADDENDUM 4.8: CATEGORY-SPECIFIC POLICY – FURNITURE
EFFECTIVE DATE: 14 MARCH 2026
OWNER: Marcus Vance, Director of Customer Operations Policy

4.8.1 RETURN WINDOW

(a) Standard items across the Kartway marketplace are subject to a 30-day return window. By exception, all items listed under the Furniture category (Department 40) are subject to an extended return window of 42 calendar days from the verified delivery date.

(b) Return authorization requests initiated on day 43 or later shall be automatically rejected by the Support Terminal unless an exception under Section 4.8.5 applies.

4.8.2 CONDITION REQUIREMENTS

((a) To qualify for a full refund under Section 4.8.1, returned furniture must be in structurally sound, un-assembled (if delivered un-assembled) or original assembled condition, free from structural cracks, water damage, pet hair, chemical odours, and fabric tears.

(b) Minor cosmetic blemishes resulting exclusively from standard indoor placement do not constitute grounds for rejection. However, items returned with active pest contamination, severe staining, or missing primary structural components (such as legs, primary support frames, or hydraulic cylinders) shall be assessed a non-negotiable damage deduction of 45% of the original purchase price.

4.8.3 ORIGINAL PACKAGING REQUIREMENTS

(a) Original manufacturer packaging (boxes, internal expanded polystyrene foam inserts, and cardboard corner guards) is not mandatory for furniture returns.

(b) Customers are permitted to return items using alternative protective packaging, provided the packaging meets Kartway Freight Protection Standard 4. Support agents shall not penalize or reject returns solely due to the absence of the original carton.

4.8.4 RESTOCKING FEES

(a) Returns of large-format furniture items (defined as any single item exceeding 75 pounds in packaged shipping weight) that are processed under "Change of Mind" or "Customer Remorse" return sub-reasons are subject to a mandatory restocking fee.

(b) The restocking fee is fixed at 15% of the item's purchase price (excluding local sales tax) and shall be automatically deducted from the customer's refund upon warehouse intake scanning.

(c)(1) Restoking fees are waived for items returned due to transit damage, manufacturing defects, or item-not-as-described claims verified by photographic evidence.

4.8.5 HAZARDOUS, PERISHABLE, AND SPECIALIZED HANDLING RULES

(a) Upholstered furniture items containing integrated electrical heating elements, massage motors, or motorized recline mechanisms must have all internal lithium-ion backup batteries removed or securely discharged prior to LTL (Less-Than-Truckload) carrier pickup, in compliance with Kartway Logistics Directive 12.

(b) Solid wood furniture items designated as tropical hardwoods (teak, mahogany) must be shrink-wrapped on standard wooden pallets if returned via freight carrier to prevent moisture absorption during transit.

4.8.6 WARRANTY PERIOD

(a) All furniture sold on the Kartway marketplace carries a minimum manufacturer-backed warranty period of 3 years from the date of purchase covering structural integrity, frame warp, joint failure, and mechanical recline mechanism failure.

(b) Surface finishes, leather softening, fabric fading, and normal wear-and-tear are excluded from the 3-year warranty coverage. Support agents shall direct warranty claims occurring after the 42-day return window directly to the designated Kartway Vendor Resolution Desk rather than issuing platform refunds.